

20 AI Prompts for Excel

Stop Googling. Start Pasting.

Paste these 20 prompts into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or any AI to get instant working Excel formulas, clean data, smart dashboards, and VBA macros. Each prompt is tested, includes example output, and saves you hours of Googling.

Works with Excel 2010 through 365. No special setup needed.

Gadget Humans | Prompt Pack v1.0

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How to Use These Prompts

Pick a prompt that matches what you need in Excel right now.

Copy the entire prompt text (including the bracketed [placeholders]).

Paste it into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, DeepSeek, or any AI chat.

Replace the bracketed parts with your actual column/sheet/data names.

The AI returns a working Excel formula. Copy it into your spreadsheet.

Done. You just saved 15 minutes of Googling.

Tip: Some prompts include example output. Use these to verify the AI gave you the right formula. If it doesn't look right, tell the AI "that didn't work, try again" - it almost always fixes it on the second attempt.

Prompt #01

Write a Formula from a Description

Use: You know what you want but not the syntax.

Write an Excel formula for [describe what you want, e.g. 'calculate the average of column B only if column A says Complete']. Use A1:A100 and B1:B100. Explain each part.

Example:

=AVERAGEIF(A1:A100,"Complete",B1:B100) averages B only where A equals 'Complete'.

Prompt #02

Clean Messy Data Instantly

Use: Inconsistent formatting, extra spaces, mixed types.

I have data in Excel column C, rows 2-500, with [describe: extra spaces / mixed text and numbers / weird chars]. Give me a formula to clean this.

Example:

=TRIM(CLEAN(C2)) removes extra spaces and non-printable characters.

Prompt #03

Build a Dynamic Dropdown List

Use: Auto-updating dropdown when source list grows.

Create a dynamic dropdown in Excel where options come from column E that grows over time. Use OFFSET or INDIRECT. Exact steps including Data Validation.

Example:

=OFFSET(Sheet1!\$E\$1,0,0,COUNTA(Sheet1!\$E:\$E),1). Data Validation -> List -> Source: =ItemList

Prompt #04

Find Duplicates Across Multiple Columns*Use: Rows matching across several columns.*

Find rows where A, B, and C all match another row. Rows 2-1000. Formula to highlight duplicates.

Example:

=COUNTIFS(A:A,A2,B:B,B2,C:C,C2)>1 via conditional formatting.

Prompt #05

Extract Text from a Cell*Use: Split 'John-Smith-Accounting' into parts.*

Column A has hyphen-separated data. Extract 1st part to B, 2nd to C, 3rd to D.

Example:

=LEFT(A2,FIND("-",A2)-1) for first part.

Prompt #06

Conditional Formatting by Another Column*Use: Highlight A cells based on B values.*

Highlight A2:A100 green if B cell contains 'Yes'. Exact CF formula and steps.

Example:

=B2="Yes" applied to \$A\$2:\$A\$100.

Prompt #07

SUMIF Across Multiple Sheets*Use: Sum same cell across 12 sheets with a condition.*

12 sheets Jan-Dec. Sum column D where column C says 'Office Supplies' across all.

Example:

=SUMPRODUCT(SUMIF(INDIRECT(...),"Office Supplies",INDIRECT(...)))

Prompt #08

Convert Dates to Text for Reports*Use: '01/15/2026' -> 'January 15, 2026' as text.*

Dates in column A. Display as 'January 15, 2026' in B as text without changing A.

Example:`=TEXT(A2,"mmm d, yyyy")`

Prompt #09

Create a Search Box That Filters Data*Use: Type to filter your table automatically.*

Search box in F1 filters table A1:D100. FILTER formula for Excel 365, workaround for older.

Example:`=FILTER(A2:D100, ISNUMBER(SEARCH(F1,A2:A100)), "No results")`

Prompt #10

Calculate Age or Tenure*Use: '3 years, 7 months' from a start date.*

Hire dates in A. Formula for years/months service. Bonus: anniversary flag.

Example:`=DATEDIF(A2, TODAY(), "Y")&"y "&DATEDIF(A2, TODAY(), "YM")&"m"`

Prompt #11

VLOOKUP to Return Multiple Columns*Use: Return name, dept, salary from one ID lookup.*

Lookup Employee ID in Sheet2 A. Return Name (B), Dept (C), Salary (D).

Example:`=XLOOKUP($A2, Sheet2!$A:$A, Sheet2!$B:$B) or INDEX/MATCH.`

Prompt #12

Highlight Expired or Expiring Dates

Use: Red=expired, Yellow=30 days, Green=valid.

Expiry dates A2:A500. Three conditional formatting rules: red/yellow/green.

Example:

=A2<TODAY() red. =AND(A2>=TODAY(),A2<=TODAY()+30) yellow.

Prompt #13

Generate a Pivot Table with Grouped Dates

Use: Daily sales into monthly totals.

Date in A, Revenue in B, 2-1000. Pivot table by month with running total.

Example:

Group dates by Month. Add Running Total to Sum of Revenue.

Prompt #14

Create an Interactive Dashboard Button

Use: One-click clear inputs and reset form.

Button that clears B2:F50, resets A1, shows 'Form Reset' message.

Example:

Range("B2:F50").ClearContents assigned to a shape.

Prompt #15

Calculate Rank with Ties

Use: Same score = same rank, no skipped numbers.

Sales B2:B100. Rank highest=1, ties get same rank.

Example:

=RANK(B2,\$B\$2:\$B\$100,0) for standard. RANK.EQ for ties.

Prompt #16

Parse Names into Parts

Use: 'Dr. John Michael Smith Jr.' structured.

Full names in A. Extract Title, First, Middle, Last, Suffix.

Example:

Text-to-Columns delimited by space, or Power Query.

Prompt #17

Create a Gantt Chart

Use: Visual project timeline without expensive software.

Tasks in A, Start in B, End in C. Gantt via conditional formatting.

Example:

=AND(D\$1>=\$B2,D\$1<=\$C2) with blue fill.

Prompt #18

Auto-Send Email on Cell Change

Use: Alert when a critical value updates.

Auto-send email via Outlook when C5 exceeds 1000.

Example:

Worksheet_Change VBA. Outlook must be installed.

Prompt #19

Build a Loan Payment Calculator

Use: Monthly payment + full amortization schedule.

Loan in B2, Rate in B3, Term in B4. Payment, interest, amortization table.

Example:

=PMT(B3/12,B4,B2) for monthly payment.

Prompt #20

Combine IF with AND/OR Logic

Use: Priority if A=Approved AND B>100 OR C=VIP.

Return 'Priority' or 'Standard' based on multiple conditions.

Example:

```
=IF(AND(A2="Approved",OR(B2>100,C2="VIP")), "Priority", "Standard")
```

What's Next?

If these prompts saved you time, you'll love our other packs for Google Sheets, Notion, Todoist, Gmail, and Obsidian.

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